COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

INDICATOR, STERILIZATION, BACTERIAL SPORE (Flash Cycles)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description describes a self-contained biological indicator suitable for use in monitoring the performance of 270 degree F. gravity steam flash cycles.

Salient characteristics. The biological indicator shall be self-contained and consist of a flexible plastic vial which has a spore strip impregnated with Bacillus stearothermophilus, and growth medium. The indicator shall have a purple color coded cap and be provided a steam process chemical indicator which shall be used to provide immediate proof of processing in the steam sterilization cycle. The indicator shall be physically and functionally compatible with AMSCO No. NA 053 Proof Steam Incubator and AMSCO No. NA 118 Large Capacity Steam or Gas Incubator. The indicator shall be used to monitor three minute, 270 degrees F. (132 degrees C.) gravity steam sterilizer flash cycles. The indicator is not suitable for use in other steam or ethylene oxide sterilization cycles.

Complete and detailed instructions for use of the indicator and incubators shall be supplied with each unit.

After the three minute flash sterilization cycle and cooling, the indicator shall be crushed to allow the medium and spores to mix. The indicator shall then be placed in the proper location in the incubator where it is observed for color change. A distinct positive color change to yellow indicates presence of appropriate live spores. No color change after appropriate incubation indicates kill of the spores.

Not less than 12 months of expiration dating shall remain at time of delivery to the Government.

Workmanship. The sterilization indicator shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

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Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 50 sterilization indicators as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract of purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the government. The government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with this commercial item description requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of zero (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one sterilization indicator as specified in this description.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

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If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description, and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE. The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN 6530-01-258-2437

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Copies of Federal Standard No. 376, Preferred Metric Units for General Use by the Federal Government and MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20420.

Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity:

DoD-MB

AGENT

DLA-DM

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

FDA-MPQAS
PHS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS VAMKC (904)
Agent VA-OSS VACO (92A)

Project No. 6530-2338

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